

Roblox: Hoax vs Harm

No, Roblox isn't shuttering because a blue-ticked "official-ish" post said so. The September 1, 2025 "shutdown" was a dressed-up prank from a parody account on X that aped corporate tone and preyed on panic. Roblox publicly swatted it down – same old hoax, new date, move along.

The reason this rumour galloped so far, was because it piggybacks on some very real heat. Louisiana's attorney general sued Roblox in August, accusing them of failing to protect children and enabling exploitation – strong language, and sobering for anyone who's ever handed a kid an iPad and exhaled. Roblox denies allegations and points to AI-driven safeguards and law-enforcement cooperation.

Globally, the safety drumbeat against Roblox is louder than the hoax. Turkey blocked access last year over abuse concerns; this August, Qatar and Kuwait joined with restrictions, while Oman and Jordan had earlier bans or limits. Even the UAE forced short-term clamps – Roblox has since toned down features region-wide and is negotiating to restore access where it's blocked. None of this equals a global shutdown, but it does equal regulators asking, "Prove you can keep kids safe."

The ugliest exhibits fueling the outrage are not imaginary. Lawsuits and AG statements cite "experiences" like "Escape to Epstein Island," and filings and investigations reference "Diddy Party"-themed worlds – ghastly pop-culture piggybacks that should never evade filters. Roblox says these violate its rules and claims a dedicated team scrubs such content. The whiplash here is the platform's promise of safety versus the whack-a-mole reality of user-generated sludge at planetary scale.

Roblox is tightening gates. The company is rolling out broader age estimation – video-selfies, government-ID checks, and parental consent – especially for chat and "Trusted Connections," where older teens can chat more freely with verified con-



"Kids deserve play without predators, just as much as parents deserve platforms that don't outsource risk to PR statements"

Gangsta Granny
feedback@skoar.in

tacts. The Verge and Wired both detail how selfie-based AI and Persona-powered checks unlock fewer filters while keeping predatory behavior monitored. Yes, privacy questions remain. Yes, the safety bar needed raising yesterday. But at least this is movement in the right direction.

Scale is the other villain. Roblox averaged 111.8 million daily users and 27.4 billion hours engaged in Q2 2025. That's a small nation's worth of chatter, uploads, and gotchas – every single day. Even with heavy automation and armies of moderators, some toxic experiences will slip through, and when they do, screenshots travel faster than fixes.

Here's my unvarnished take, though. Kids deserve play without predators, just as much as parents deserve platforms that don't outsource risk to PR statements, and regulators deserve more than hand-waving about "AI safety at scale." Roblox must prove that its age gates, AI filters, and regional compliance aren't theater. That means faster takedowns of exploitative "experiences," default-tight chat for minors, and radical transparency: publish safety metrics that matter (time-to-removal, recidivism rates, appeal outcomes) the same way you crow about DAUs.

Parents should stop treating "free-to-play" as "set-and-forget." Verify ages, lock down chat, audit friend lists, and use device-level limits. If an "experience" sounds like a tabloid headline, it's not enrichment – it's bait. Players should report, block, bounce. If you see something engineered to shock, someone is trying to farm your attention.

Final word? The shutdown rumour was bunk. The safety problem, however, is not. Now more than ever, Roblox – and every UGC platform – must treat child safety like uptime, something that's like a non-negotiable SLO with public dashboards and painful consequences when missed. So, keep an eye on the parental controls and the patch notes. Fun should be frictionless, but sadly safeguarding never is. *